

Before your sedation appointment

IV MODERATE SEDATION · PATIENT GUIDE

Please read fully
Call our office with any questions

You're scheduled for a procedure with IV sedation. A small IV in your arm will deliver medication that keeps you relaxed and comfortable. Most people don't remember much of the appointment afterward. This guide will help you prepare safely — the most important parts are on this page.

2 DAYS BEFORE	DAY BEFORE	8 HOURS BEFORE	1 HOUR BEFORE	DAY OF	AFTER
Start your antibiotic & Peridex rinse, if prescribed.	No alcohol. Stop bleeding-risk supplements.	Nothing to eat or drink. Count back from your appointment time.	Triazolam, if prescribed. Approved meds. Small sip of water only.	Arrive with your escort. Loose clothes.	24h supervision · 24h no driving.

1 Eating & drinking

An empty stomach keeps you safe during sedation. The rule is **eight hours** — count back from your appointment time and stop then. Please follow this exactly.

WHEN	WHAT'S ALLOWED
Your last meal	Eat a normal, light meal before your eight-hour window starts. Avoid heavy, fatty, or fried foods.
8 hours before	Nothing to eat or drink. No food, no water, no coffee, no gum, no mints, no candy.
1 hour before	You may take your approved medications, and your triazolam if prescribed, with a <i>small</i> sip of water — no more than a teaspoon. This does not break your fast.

⚠ **If you accidentally eat or drink inside your eight-hour window, call us before coming in.** We may need to reschedule. This rule exists because food or liquid in your stomach can enter your lungs under sedation — rare, but serious.

i **How to count your eight hours.** For an **8:00 am** appointment, that means nothing after **midnight**. For a **4:00 pm** appointment, nothing after **8:00 am** — you do not need to fast from midnight. If you're not sure, call us.

2 Medications & supplements

Follow these unless we gave you different directions at your consultation.

TAKE THE MORNING OF

- Blood pressure medications — with a small sip of water
- Heart, seizure, thyroid, and most daily prescriptions
- Inhalers if you use them
- If prescribed: your antibiotic and Peridex (chlorhexidine) rinse, started 2 days before surgery — take the antibiotic as directed and rinse morning and night
- If prescribed: **triazolam** — swallow one tablet **one hour before** your appointment with a small sip of water. It eases nerves but is not required. If you forget it, that's okay: it will not affect your sedation and your surgery goes ahead as planned.

HOLD THE MORNING OF

- Diabetes medications — contact **our office** for instructions before your appointment; some (Jardiance, Farxiga, Invokana, Steglatro) must be stopped 3–4 days ahead
- Any medication we specifically told you to stop

Stop 3–5 days before (if your prescriber approves): fish oil, vitamin E, garlic pills, ginkgo, turmeric/curcumin, bromelain, high-dose ginger. These can increase bleeding.

i **Never stop prescription blood thinners on your own.** If you take warfarin, Eliquis, Xarelto, Plavix, or similar, we'll coordinate with your prescribing doctor.

i **Taking a GLP-1 medication such as Ozempic, Wegovy, Mounjaro, or Zepbound?** Keep taking it as prescribed and tell our office before your appointment. Our office policy for all patients on these medications: clear liquids only (no solid food) for the 24 hours before your 8-hour fasting window begins.

3 The days before your appointment

- ✗ No marijuana/cannabis in any form, and no smoking or vaping *anything*, for **72 hours** before your appointment — this is our office policy for elective sedation, and it protects your airway and heart
- ✗ No other recreational drugs for 72 hours before
- ✗ No alcohol for 24 hours before — it interacts with sedation medications
- ✗ Let us know right away if you develop a cold, cough, fever, sore throat, or flu
- ✗ If there's any chance you could be pregnant, please tell us before we start

4 Your escort & the adult with you after

A responsible adult (18 or older) must come with you, stay, and take you home. This is required — we can't begin your sedation without it. It's the escort, not the car, that keeps you safe: riding home together in a taxi or rideshare is fine.

WHAT YOUR ESCORT NEEDS TO DO

- Come inside with you at check-in
- Stay in the office during your procedure — no exceptions
- Take you directly home — driving you themselves, or riding with you in a taxi or rideshare
- Stay with you for **the rest of the day and overnight (24 hours)** after discharge

WHAT DOESN'T WORK

- Uber, Lyft, taxi, or bus on your own
- Walking or biking home
- Anyone who only drops you off or only picks you up — your escort comes in with you, stays, and goes home with you
- Driving yourself — not for 24 hours after sedation

5 What to wear & bring

WEAR

- ✓ Short sleeves, or sleeves that roll above the elbow (for the IV)
- ✓ Loose, comfortable clothing
- ✓ Flat, closed-toe shoes
- ✓ Glasses instead of contact lenses

SKIP OR REMOVE

- ✗ Makeup, lipstick, lip balm
- ✗ Nail polish or acrylics on at least one finger (we monitor oxygen through your fingertip)
- ✗ Jewelry, especially piercings
- ✗ Heavy perfume or cologne

Bring: photo ID, insurance card, a current list of your medications (with doses), and your escort.

6 After your procedure

Sedation medication stays in your body longer than you feel it. Even if you feel fine, your judgment and reflexes are not back to normal for a full day.

FIRST 24 HOURS · HAVE AN ADULT WITH YOU

- Rest quietly at home
- Someone must stay with you — don't be alone
- Sip water and eat light foods as your stomach allows
- Take your pain medication as directed
- Follow the post-op instructions for your specific procedure

FIRST 24 HOURS · DO NOT

- ✗ Drive a car or operate machinery
- ✗ Return to work, school, or exercise
- ✗ Sign contracts or make important decisions
- ✗ Drink alcohol, use cannabis, or take medications we didn't approve
- ✗ Care for children or pets on your own

i It's completely normal to feel drowsy, slightly nauseated, or a bit wobbly for several hours. Many people don't remember parts of the day — this is expected and will not come back.

i Breastfeeding? You may resume nursing as soon as you are awake, stable, and alert — there is no need to pump and discard milk (American Society of Anesthesiologists & Academy of Breastfeeding Medicine guidance). For a newborn, preterm, or medically fragile infant, ask your pediatrician whether a brief 6–12 hour pause is prudent.

Call our office if...

- You develop a cold, flu, fever, or sore throat before your appointment
- You accidentally ate or drank inside the NPO window
- Your escort arrangement falls through
- You're unsure about any of your medications
- You could be pregnant
- After your procedure: heavy bleeding that won't stop, trouble breathing, chest pain, severe pain not controlled by medication, or fever over 101°F

After hours, call our office and follow the instructions to reach the on-call provider. If you truly cannot breathe or have chest pain, call 911.

We'd rather answer a question before your appointment than have you worry about it. If anything here is unclear — especially about medications, eating, or your escort — please call our office.